

Control Panel > Desktop and disable View my Active Desktop as a web page. This should solve the problem.

Sharp CMYK graphs

Q. I have a problem while creating pie, line and bar graphs for CMYK printing using PageMaker. I use Excel for preparing the charts, but it uses only RGB and the lines are jagged. I import this graph in CorelDRAW and edit it to smoothen out the lines and convert it to CMYK, which takes a lot of time. Illustrator does not have enough features for making graphs. In your magazine, you use charts and graphs with shadows. Please let me know what you use and the best procedure to draw a graph in CMYK for print processing.

Ramesh N.

Via e-mail

A We create charts and graphs in Macromedia Freehand. These are then imported to Photoshop where effects such as shadows and bevels are added. There's not much you can do about either of your problems with Excel, so working in Freehand and Corel is your next best option.

Partitioning blues

Q. I tried partitioning my hard disk using the partitioning software on the June 2002 CD. It is now showing two drives, one (C) of 16 GB and another (D) of 19.6 GB. Drive C uses a FAT file system and D uses FAT32. However, when I try to load any operating

system on C, it gives a message that there is insufficient space. It gets installed correctly on D though. How do I correct this?

Anil Kumar

Via e-mail

A The drive does not seem to have been partitioned correctly—any partition over 2 GB cannot have a FAT file system. You have not mentioned what operating system you use; the process for fixing this will differ slightly across different versions of Windows. Boot to DOS and run FDISK. Hit [Y] when it asks you whether you want to enable support for large disks. You can delete the primary partition (C) and recreate it. If D has been created as a logical partition, you will have to delete this first. If you don't want to delete it and have Windows 98, try converting C to FAT32 using the FAT32 converter available with the OS. If you have Windows 2000 or later, you can simply use Disk Manager to do the job.

CMOS battery

Q. I want to know how to turn off the CMOS battery. If a user is not using the PC for a long time, does the battery get drained? Is there anything we can do about this? Will the removal of battery cause any adverse effect?

Santosh Ambekar

Via e-mail

A The purpose of the CMOS battery is to retain the CMOS configuration while the PC is off. You don't really need to disable it unless you are planning to not use the PC for around a year. However, if you still want to do this, you can remove the battery from the mother-

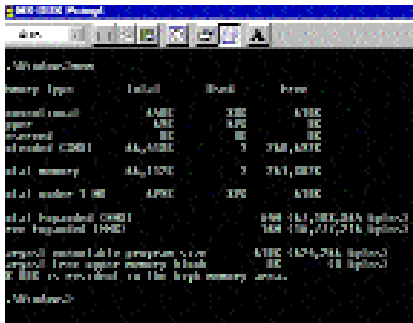
board. The next time you boot the PC, the CMOS will default to the factory settings and any configuration changes made to it will be lost.

DOS conventional memory

Q. I have a Cyrix processor with 32 MB RAM. When I try playing any DOS game on it, it says that the conventional memory is not sufficient. What will I have to do to run my games in DOS?

Ravi Kishore

Vishakhapatnam



Check the amount of free memory in DOS

A This is a very old problem with a crude workaround solution. While in DOS, type **mem** to check the amount of unused memory. Don't get boggled by the numbers—it might not show the amount of RAM on your PC accurately. You are interested only in the value of Free Conventional Memory. Open **c:\config.sys** for editing. Type the following lines at the top:

```
DEVICE=C:\WINDOWS\HIMEM.SYS /testmem:off
DEVICE=C:\WINDOWS\EMM386.EXE RAM
DOS=HIGH
DOS=UMB
```

Save the file and restart the PC in DOS. Check the amount of free memory, which should have increased substantially now. If the games still don't run, the soundcard or the mouse drivers are probably taking up some memory. Check if the game can run without either of these and unload the unnecessary one. If you need

both, try preceding their load commands in the **autoexec.bat** with **LH C:\DRIVERS\MOUSE.COM**. This will load the drivers in the upper memory area and free up some more conventional memory for you to run your game.

Selective MP3 player

Q. I bought a Samsung MCD-SM60 portable MP3-CD player. It plays most of the CDs and MP3 CDs. However, when I try to play MP3 CDs created with Adaptec Easy CD Creator, the player recognises only some files out of the 100 or so on it. Do I need any special software for burning the CD?

Sumit

Via e-mail

A Since the player recognises some files and not others, it

probably negates a lot of possible errors such as the media, burning errors and so on. This seems to be more of a file error. Check the bitrate at which the MP3s are encoded. Avoid using extremely high bitrates; 96 or 128 Kbps should be enough. Also avoid variable bitrates (VBR). If these fail, try burning the CD at a lower speed.

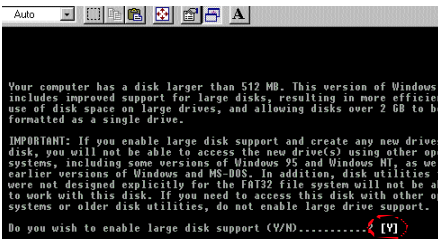
Compress video with DivX

Q. I have read a lot about DivX in the past couple of months in your magazine. Though I have visited numerous sites, I could not get an answer to my query. I want to convert my VCDs to DivX format to save space. How can I do that?

Amit

Via e-mail

A To convert video formats to DivX, you will have to use a software that can encode with this codec. You can use freeware such as VirtualDub



Enable support for large disks in Fdisk to create FAT32 partitions